

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 8 2
 ♥ 9 8 6 5 2
 ♦ 7 4
 ♣ 7 3

♠ K Q 7

♥ K Q J 3

♦ A 10 6

♣ Q 10 8



♠ 6 5 3

♥ 10 4

♦ Q J 9 5 2

♣ A 5 4

♠ A 9 4

♥ A 7

♦ K 8 3

♣ K J 9 6 2

NORTH has a maximum 17 point 1NT bid.

SOUTH, with 16 points, can't tell if there are enough points for slam. If NORTH has 17 points then a slam should be makeable, but if NORTH has only 15 points then he should settle for game.

The 4NT raise solves the problem. It tells NORTH to bid 6NT with 17 points, pass with 15 points, and use best judgment with 16. Here NORTH bids the slam.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1NT	Pass	4NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by North			

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5
♥ A K 10 9
♦ J 8 3 2
♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ K 9 7 3

♥ 8 4 2

♦ A K 5

♣ J 7 6



♠ J 10 4

♥ Q 7 6

♦ Q 10 9 6

♣ A 8 5

♠ A Q 8 6 2

♥ J 5 3

♦ 7 4

♣ K Q 2

NORTH has just 11 points, not enough to open the bidding. But when SOUTH opens 1♠ NORTH should show her "almost opening strength" by jumping to 3♠.

SOUTH has just 13 points, and knowing NORTH has less than 13 he passes.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

Pass

1♠

Pass

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by South

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 9 6 5
♥ J 9
♦ 9 2
♣ A J 7 3 2

♠ 10 8 2
♥ A K 7 5 3
♦ K Q 5
♣ Q 6



♠ K Q J 4
♥ 10
♦ J 10 7 4 3
♣ 10 8 4

♠ 7 3
♥ Q 8 6 4 2
♦ A 8 6
♣ K 9 5

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

After NORTH opens with 1 ♥, SOUTH has a small "dilemma". With 11 points she really is only strong enough to make a jump raise to 3 ♥. But, with five trumps the hand deserves more. So she just bids 4 ♥ instead.

Usually, no matter what your strength, when you have five cards in the Major suit that your partner opens with you should just jump right to game.